MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE 60MM, TP, M50A3
LOADING, ASSEMBLING MD PACKING

This specification is approved for use within the U.S. Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements and quality assurance provisions for loading, assembling and packing of the Cartridge, 60mm, TP, M50A3.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-A-48087 - Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification for
MIL-P-60316 - Primer, Percussion; M32, Loading, Assembling and Packing

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, U.S. Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command, Attn. AMSMC-QA, Picatinny Arsenal, New Jersey 07806-5000 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 1310
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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings and publications form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWING (See 6.4)

U.S. ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT AND ENGINEERING CENTER (ARDEC)

PRODUCT AND PACKAGING DRAWING

9220383 - Cartridge, 60MM, TP, M50A3
9220014 - Container, Ammunition, Fiber, M576, 60MM Cartridge HE M49A2E2 or TP M50A3 in Jungle Wrap
9220015 - Box, Packing, Ammunition for 60MM Cartridge HE M49A2E2 or TP M50A3 in Fiber Container M576 in Jungle Wrap

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings, and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of conflict between the text of this specification and the reference cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards) , the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings and specifications, and this specification.

3.2 Cartridge. The cartridge shall comply with all requirements specified on drawing (dwg.) 9220383 and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

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3.3 Ballistic performance (proving ground). The cartridges shall comply with the requirements (see 4.4.3.2)

3.3.1 Misfires. The cartridges shall not fail to fire from the weapon.

3.3.2 Premature functioning. There shall be no premature functioning in the mortar tube or within 100 meters travel from the mortar tube.

3.3.3 Functioning. There shall be visible evidence of functioning upon impact as indicated by the presence of a flash or smoke cloud to its maximum range (see 6.5).

3.3.4 Metal parts separation. There shall be no metal parts separation in the mortar tube or in flight.

3.3.5 Range precision. The horizontal range standard deviation shall be no greater than 18.0 meters when fired at charge “zero and no greater than 43.0 meters when fired at charge four.

3.3.5.1 Short rounds. No cartridge shall have a horizontal range less than 80 percent of the average horizontal range when calculated without the short rounds.

3.4 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with the technical provisions herein. (See 4.3 and 6.1).

3.5 Workmanship. Threads shall be full and undamaged for the entire minimum length or depth. No part may have a burr which might interfere with the assembly or function of the round or which might be injurious to personnel handling the item. All parts shall be free of chips or foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any of the parts, nor shall the parts be contaminated with residue. All required markings shall be neat and sharply defined.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other

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facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made a part of this detail specification.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of section 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply, with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The following types of inspection shall be conducted on this item:

a. First Article Inspection

b. Quality Conformance Inspection

4.3 First article inspection

4.3.1 Submission. The contractor shall submit a first article sample as designated by the Contracting Officer for evaluation in accordance with provision of 4.3.2. The first article sample shall consist of the items as required per Table I.

4.3.2 Inspections to be Performed. See MIL-A-48078 and Table I specified herein.

4.3.3 Rejection. See MIL-A-48078.

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TABLE I. First article inspection

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-48697 (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE: Cartridge, 60MM, TP, M50A3 Assembly	SHEET 1 OF 1	DRAWING NUMBER: See Below
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Body Loading Assembly (Dwg. 9220384) Examination for defects	20		3.2	4.4.2.1
	Cartridge (Dwg. 9220383) Examination for defects	20		3.2	4.4.2.2/4.4.2.3./ 4.4.2.4/4.4.2.5
	Ballistic Test (Proving Ground)	80		3.3	4.4.3.2/4.5.1

NOTES:

AMSMC Form 1570a, 1 Apr 85

Replaces DRDAR-QA Form 160a, 1 Jun 83, which may not be used.

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection

4.4.1 Inspection lot formation. Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provisions of MIL-A-48078. In addition, inspection lots of Cartridges shall contain:

a. Metal parts and metal parts assemblies of one lot interfix from one manufacturer.

b. Ignition cartridges of one lot interfix from one manufacturer.

c. Fin assemblies of one lot interfix from one manufacturer.

d. Loaded primers of one lot interfix from one manufacturer.

e. Propellant increments made from one lot of propellant from one manufacturer.

f. Fuzes of one lot interfix from one manufacturer.

g. Pellets (black powder) of one lot interfix from one manufacturer.

4.4.2 Examination. See MIL-A-48078. Unless otherwise specified in the Classification of Defects and Test Tables, sampling plans for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level II.

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Body Loading Assembly, Prior to Assembly of Felt Pad, Pellet, Black Powder of Fuze	1 OF 1	9220384
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: 9220383

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None defined				
Major					
101	Depth of fuze-marker pellet well, min.		0.40%	3.2	Gage
102	Foreign matter in fuze well		0.40%	3.2	Visual
Minor					
201	Depth of fuze-black powder pellet well, max.		0.65%	3.2	Gage
202	Diameter of fuze-black powder pellet well, max.		0.65%	3.2	Gage
203	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-48697 (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.2	Cartridge, Prior to Inserting Fuze				9220383
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None defined				
Major					
101	Felt pad or black powder pellet missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual
102	Foreign matter in fuze-black powder pellet well		0.40%	3.2	Visual
Minor					
201	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-48697 (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.3	Cartridge, Prior to Inserting Primer				9220383
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical					
1	Ignition cartridge missing or inverted		100%	3.2	Visual
Major					
101	Fin or fin extension torque improper		0.40%	3.2	Gage
102	Fuze torque improper		0.40%	3.2	Gage
103	Fin extension to fin and shell body pettman cement missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual
Minor					
201	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

Replaces DRSMC-QA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83, which may not be used

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.4	Cartridge, 60MM, TP, M50A3 Assembly	1 OF 1	9220383
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical					
1	Primer head above flush with rear surface of fin cartridge container		100%	3.2	Gage
2	Fin broken or distorted		100%	3.2	Visual
Major					
101	Total length, max.		0.40%	3.2	Gage
102	Primer stake missing or thread sealing compound does not cover a minimum of half the number of male primer threads for full 360 degrees (after disassembly, as applicable)		0.40%	3.2	Visual
103	Any component damaged or incorrectly assembled (except as described by Critical 2 above)		0.40%	3.2	Visual
104	Primer fails to withstand reapplication of minimum assembly torque		0.40%	3.2	Gage
Minor					
201	Protective coating damaged in excess of 1/4 square inch		0.65%	3.2	Visual
202	Marking missing or unidentifiable		0.65%	3.2	Visual
203	Fuze not fully seated		0.65%	3.2	Visual
204	Pettman cement application improper		0.65%	3.2	Visual
205	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual
	Ballistic Performance				
	Proving ground ballistic acceptance	80/48		3.3	4.4.3.2/4.5.1

NOTES:

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.5	Unsealed Fiber Container				9220383/9220014
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9220015
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical					
1	Propellant increment missing		100%	3.2	Visual
2	Fuze pull wire missing or not fully seated		100%	3.2	Gage
Major					
101	Propellant increment cut or torn		100%	3.2	Visual
102	Profile and alignment		100%	3.2	Gage
103	Packing component missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual
104	Filler assembly missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual
Minor					
201	Glue or asphalt on round		0.65%	3.2	Visual
202	Cartridge improperly assembled into container		0.65%	3.2	Visual
203	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.6	Sealed Fiber Container				9220014
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9220015
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None defined				
Major					
101	Container damaged or cut through all asphalt impregnated layers		0.40%	3.2	Visual
102	Tape incomplete or badly wrinkled		0.40%	3.2	Visual
103	Metal end loose or distorted		0.40%	3.2	Visual
Minor					
201	Sealing strip improperly applied		0.65%	3.2	Visual
202	Gap between cover and body of container excessive		0.65%	3.2	Visual
203	Contents loose		0.65%	3.2	Visual/Manual
204	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.7	Sealed Wood Packing Box				9220015
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None defined				
Major					
101	Contents exposed		0.40%	3.2	Visual
102	DOD symbol missing or incorrect		0.40%	3.2	Visual
103	Board broken or split		0.40%	3.2	Visual
104	Hardware of strapping missing, broken or loose		0.40%	3.2	Visual
Minor					
201	Hardware improperly engaged		0.65%	3.2	Visual/Manual
202	Car seal missing, unsealed or improperly positioned		0.65%	3.2	Visual/Manual
203	Contents loose		0.65%	3.2	Visual/Manual
204	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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4.4.3 Testing. Testing is described in the First Article and Quality Conformance Tables.

4.4.3.1 Check test for deterioration of primer, percussion, M32. If the total elapsed time between original acceptance of the M32= primer lot and the assembly of that lot into the ignition cartridge exceeds two years, *or* if the M32 primers have been subjected to adverse conditions for any period of time since previous test, the M32 primer lot shall be subjected to and must satisfactorily pass the check test for deterioration specified in MIL-P-60316 immediately before the M32 primer lot is assembled into the ignition cartridges.

4.4.3.2 Proving ground test (see 3.3). The cartridges shall be observed for the following characteristics:

a. Misfires, Major defect (see 3.3.1)
b. premature burst, Critical defect (see 3.3.2)
c. Impact functioning, Major defect (see 3.3.3)
d. Metal parts -separation, Special defect (see 3.3.4)
e. Range precision, Major defect (see 3.3.5)
f. Short rounds, Critical defect (see 3.3.5.1.)

Testing shall be as specified in 4.5.1.

4.4.3.2.1 Initial Sampling. Beginning with the first article and continuing until three consecutive lots have complied with the acceptance criteria specified herein, eighty (80) random sample cartridges shall be selected from each lot for this test. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. Two or more misfires occur
b. Four or more improperly impact functioning occur
c. One or more short rounds occur
d. One or more premature burst occurs
e. One or more metal parts separation occurs
f. Horizontal range standard deviation at charge O or charge 4 is exceeded

4.4.3.2.2 Production Sampling. After three consecutive lots have complied with the criteria of 4.4.3.2.1, forty-eight random sample cartridges shall be selected from each lot for this test. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. Two or more misfires occur
b. Three or more improper impact functioning occur
c. One or more short rounds occur

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d. One or more premature burst occur
e. One or more metal parts separation occur
f. Horizontal rage standard deviation at charge 0 or charge 4, if exceeded

4.4.4 Inspection equipment. The inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein is described in the “Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method" column in the tables starting with paragraph 4.4.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and 6.2 herein.

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 Proving ground test. The test shall be performed at a Government proving Ground in accordance with the applicable USATECOM Acceptance Test Procedure.

The cartridges for first article and production lot acceptance shall be conditioned at 70°F ± 2.5°F. The sample for the first three production lots (80) shall be separated into two equal groups; one group tested at charge zero, and one group tested at charge four.

After three consecutive lots have complied with the acceptance requirements the production lot sample (48) shall be separated into two groups; one group tested at charge zero, and one group tested at charge four.

The cartridge shall be fired from a standard 60MM LWCMS M224 (or equivalent ballistic tube) mortar at an elevation of forty-five degrees from a ground mount within two minutes after removal from the conditioning chamber. All fuzes shall be set to Superquick (SQ) functioning. The individual velocities, pressures, deflections, and ranges shall be recorded on the firing record.

Observation shall be made for misfires and improper impact functioning (duds or no evidence of flash or smoke), and shall be recorded. Should a premature burst or metal parts separation occur, a photograph shall be taken of the evidence and attached to the firing record. The velocity and range standard deviations and arithmetic averages shall be calculated and recorded. Range probable error shall be calculated and recorded. Temperature of the day, weather and the time of firing shall also be recorded.

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Hawk radar shall be used to observe for metal parts separation, unobserved short rounds and unobserved duds. In these events, an analysis should be made of the radar data and should be noted on the firing record. This shall include a comparison of times of flight of the unobserved rounds with that of the normal rounds. Prints of the radar traces of these rounds, and prints of the preceding and succeeding rounds, shall be attached to the firing record. Data from ballistically acceptable lots may be discarded.

A smear camera shall be used to photograph all test samples. The camera shall be positioned to pick up each round just outside the second velocity coil. Should an unobserved dud, short round or any other abnormal performance occur, a photo print of these rounds, and prints of all the other rounds in that particular charge zone, shall be attached to the firing record. Film from acceptable lots may be discarded.

4.5.1.1 Test validity. If for any reason the proving ground personnel considers that the test conditions have detrimentally affected the test result, the test results shall be declared invalid and a new test shall be performed on additional sample cartridges.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Unit packaging.

5.1.1 Level A. Packaging shall be as specified on drawing (dwg.) 9220014.

5.1.2 Level B. Not applicable.

5.1.3 Level C. Not applicable

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A. Packing shall be as specified on dwg. 9220015.

5.2.2 Level B. Not applicable.

5.2.3 Level C. Not applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Level A. Marking for unit packaging shall be as specified on dwg. 9220014. Marking for packing shall be as specified on dwg. 9220015.

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5.3.2 Level B. Not applicable.

5.3.3 Level C. Not applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. See MIL-A-48078 (AR)

6.2 Submission of designs for approval. See MIL-A-48078 (AR). Submit equipment designs, as required, to Commander, U.S. Army Armament Munitions and Chemical Command, ATTN: AMSMC-QAT-I, Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000. This address will be specified on the Contract Data Requirements List, DD Form 1423 in the contract. Unless otherwise specified, data item DI-R-1714 will apply

6.3 Submission of test data. One copy of proving ground ballistic acceptance test data (i.e., firing record) shall be forwarded to each of the following:

Commander
U.S. Army Armament Munitions and Chemical Command
ATTN: AMSMC-QAT-B(D) & SMCAR-FSA-IM
Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000

6.4 Drawings. Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament Research, Development and Engineering Center (ARDEC) may also include drawings prepared by, and identified as US Army Armament Research and Development Command (ARRADCOM) , Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal or Picatinny Arsenal drawings. Technical data originally prepared by these activities is now under the cognizance of ARDEC.

6.5. Impact functioning. The cartridges shall function with sufficient fragmentation of the projectile to adequately give visible evidence of the impact area out to its maximum range as indicated by the presence of a flash.

6.6 Subject term (keyword) listing.

Body loading assembly
Cartridge
Fin extension
Percussion primer

Custodian:
Army-AR

Preparing activity:
Army-AR

(Project 1310-A372)

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-48697	CARTRIDGE 60MM, TP, M50A3 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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